Case Study: Cyberbullying Among College Students

Cyberbullying is a form of online harassment where individuals use digital platforms such as social media, messaging apps, or forums to threaten, embarrass, or target others. It is a growing concern among students, especially in college environments.

A typical case begins when a student posts content online—such as a photo or opinion—that attracts negative attention. The bully may start by leaving insulting comments or sending hurtful messages. Gradually, the situation escalates as the bully creates fake accounts, spreads rumors, or shares edited images to publicly humiliate the victim. In some cases, private conversations or personal data are leaked without consent, increasing the emotional impact.

Students who appear socially vulnerable, new to college, or less confident are often targeted. Victims may also include those who express unpopular opinions or stand out in any way. The anonymity of the internet makes it easier for bullies to act without immediate consequences.

The effects of cyberbullying can be serious. Victims may experience anxiety, loss of confidence, academic decline, and social withdrawal. In extreme cases, it can lead to long-term psychological distress. For perpetrators, consequences may include disciplinary action by the institution, suspension, or even legal consequences under cybercrime laws.

This case highlights the importance of responsible online behavior, awareness, and timely reporting to prevent and address cyberbullying effectively